

Unrot Daily Challenge

Turn 5-minute learning into a daily habit.

Learning occasionally → a reason to return every day.

The Problem

Users learn, but nothing brings them back tomorrow.

The Intervention

A lightweight daily challenge with visible progress and rewards.

The Goal

Improve D1 retention through habit formation—not a product redesign.

THE PROBLEM

Unrot helps users learn AI. But what brings them back tomorrow?

Current State

Users discover lessons and learn. The experience delivers genuine value. But it feels **episodic**—a one-time visit rather than a daily habit.

The Gap

After completing a lesson, users face three invisible barriers:

- No clear **next action** to take
- Progress is **invisible**—there's nothing to return to
- No compelling **reason to come back** the following day

The Opportunity

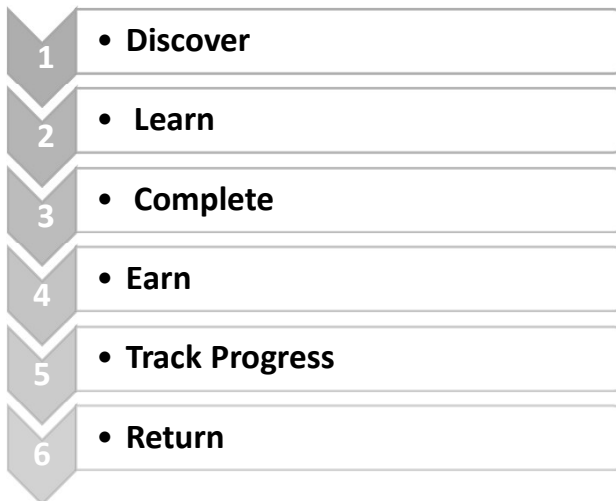
A lightweight daily challenge can create habit formation and strengthen D1 retention. Learning is valuable—but **value alone doesn't create daily habits**. Structure, progress, and reward do.

HYPOTHESIS

Our hypothesis

If we give users an immediate product experience and introduce a lightweight daily challenge with visible progress and rewards, users will have a stronger motivation to return the following day, improving D1 retention.

The Behavioral Loop



❑ **Hypothesis — to be validated through testing.** This is a directional bet, not a guaranteed outcome. Validation metrics are defined in slide 9.

ONBOARDING

Experience value before asking for commitment

The core principle: users must feel Unrot's value **before** the product asks them to commit to a daily habit. We preserve the existing onboarding flow—we add a value moment, not a redesign.

1

Existing Onboarding

User selects interests and sets learning goals

2

"You're all set 🎉"

Confirmation moment — transition to product

3

First Lesson Preview

How Generative AI Actually Works · 5 min · Beginner

4

Experience Unrot

User completes the lesson — value delivered

5

Home Screen

Daily challenge waiting. Context is set. Return is primed.

Key Principle

First value moment happens **immediately**. We insert one step — the First Lesson Preview — into an existing flow. No redesign. Maximum leverage.

Why This Matters

Users who experience product value before being asked to return are far more likely to actually return. The challenge feels earned, not imposed.

PROTOTYPE

The proposed experience

A 7-screen prototype journey, each screen following Unrot's visual language: **dark UI, white typography, purple accents, rounded cards, minimal design.**



Onboarding

Personalize interests and goals. Sets the foundation for a relevant daily challenge.



First Lesson

Demonstrate immediate value. The user learns something real before any commitment is requested.



Daily Challenge

Create today's goal. A specific, time-boxed objective that primes return behavior.



Lesson

Deliver 5-minute learning. Short, focused, completable in a single session.



Reward

Reinforce completion with XP and streak. The moment that creates tomorrow's pull.



Home

Make next action obvious. Today's challenge surfaced immediately on return.



Progress

Make habit visible. Streak, XP, and weekly stats create accountability at a glance.

THE LOOP

Turn learning into a daily loop

The challenge → reward → return cycle. Each element is designed to pull the user forward to the next session.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Complete your first AI lesson

5 minutes · Reward: +50 XP

CHALLENGE COMPLETE

+50 XP ·  1 Day Streak

You're on a roll. Come back tomorrow to keep it going.

» TOMORROW'S CHALLENGE

Understand AI Agents · 5 min

Teased immediately on the reward screen.

Why This Loop Works

The reward screen does two jobs simultaneously: it closes today's loop and opens tomorrow's. The user leaves with a concrete reason to return.

Gamification Philosophy

Gamification here is **lightweight by design**. XP and streaks are tools for habit formation—not leaderboard competition. The goal is a user who returns because the product fits into their day, not because they're chasing a rank.

The Behavioral Insight

Streaks create loss aversion in the best way: users who have a 1-day streak are motivated to make it 2. The challenge naming tomorrow's lesson is a commitment device — the user knows exactly what they're returning for.

0 Make the next action obvious

The redesigned home screen is organized around a single product principle: **reduce decision fatigue by surfacing the right action at the right moment.**

1 What should I do?

 **TODAY'S LEARNING** —
Understand AI Agents · 5 min ·
Beginner. A single, prominent call-to-
action. No ambiguity about where to
start.

2 Why should I keep doing it?

 **YOUR PROGRESS** — 1 day streak ·
50 XP · 50 XP to next level. Visible
progress reinforces the habit. Users
can see momentum building.

3 What else can I explore?

EXPLORE — AI News · Workshops ·
Interview Prep. Discovery is available,
but it never competes with the
primary action.

The Hierarchy Principle

Action first. Progress second. Exploration third. This order is intentional: the home screen serves returning users who need a clear on-ramp, not a browsing experience. Every pixel of the home screen earns its place by reducing the distance between opening the app and starting a lesson.

Make progress visible — without making competition the product

WEEKLY STATS

4 Lessons Completed

20 min Learning Time

220 XP Earned

 4-day streak

Weekly Challenge Progress

4 / 5 days completed — 80%

One session away from completing the week.

WEEKLY LEADERBOARD

Rank	User	XP
1	Alex	520 XP
2	Sarah	480 XP
3	Rahul	430 XP
...	...	...
7	You	220 XP

Design Note: Leaderboard as Layer, Not Core

The leaderboard is an **additional motivation layer**, not the product's core loop. The core loop is: **Learning → XP → Progress → Streak → Return**. Social comparison is opt-in context, not the engine. Users who ignore the leaderboard entirely still experience the full habit-forming loop.

VALIDATION

How we will know if it works

Primary Metric

D1 Retention

Does the intervention increase the percentage of users who return the following day?

Experiment Design

Control: Existing Unrot experience, unchanged.

Test: First Lesson Preview + Daily Challenge + XP / Streak + Visible Progress

We measure impact on D1 retention and supporting engagement metrics.

This is a hypothesis to be validated, not a guaranteed outcome.

Secondary Metrics

Challenge Completion

Daily Challenge completion rate per cohort

Lesson Completion

Lesson completion rate within first session

First-Session Start

Rate of lesson start in the first session

Reward → Return

Next-day return rate from reward screen

Streak Continuation

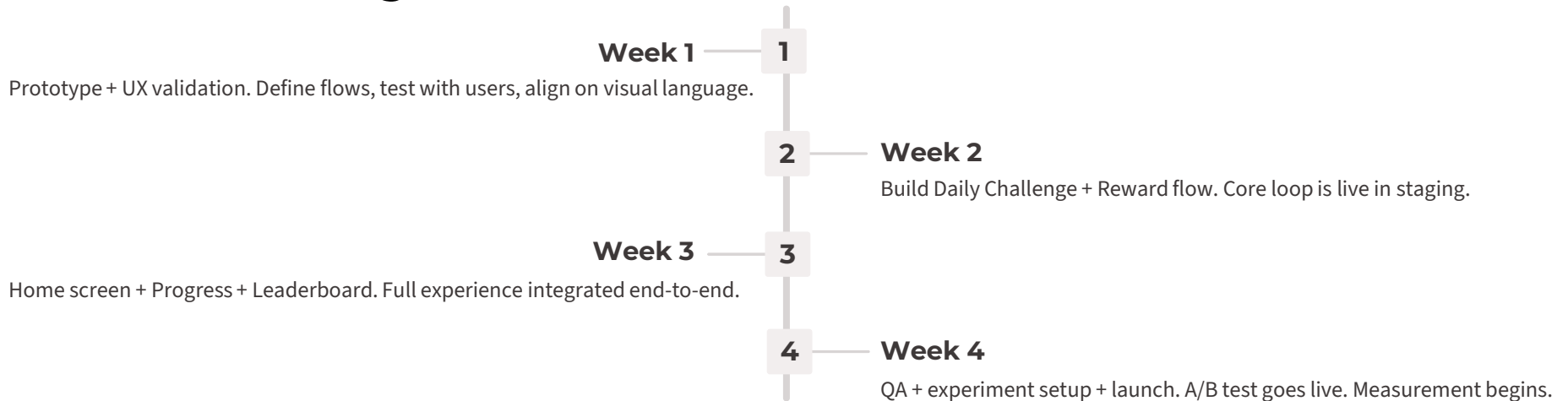
% of users who maintain streak day-over-day

Weekly Challenge

Weekly challenge completion rate (5/5 days)

EXECUTION

Focused enough to build in 4 weeks



The Final Loop

Discover → Learn → Complete → Earn → Track → Return

The Bet

Unrot Daily Challenge turns a 5-minute lesson into a reason to come back tomorrow.

The Method

Hypothesis-led. Lightweight to build. Designed to validate retention impact — not assume it.

📌 **This is a focused intervention on an existing product.** The foundation is Unrot. The add is a daily challenge layer. The goal is a measurable improvement in D1 retention — validated through experiment, not assumed through design.